

Table 1. Criteria used to classify alien taxa by EICAT impact category (MC, MN, MO, MR, MV).

	Massive (MV)	Major (MR)	Moderate (MO)	Minor (MN)	Minimal Concern (MC)
Categories should adhere to the following general meaning	Causes local extinction of at least one native taxon (i.e., taxa vanish from communities at sites where they occurred before the alien arrived), which is naturally irreversible: even if the alien taxon is no longer present the native taxon cannot recolonise the area	Causes local or sub-population extinction of at least one native taxon (i.e., taxa vanish from communities at sites where they occurred before the alien arrived); which is naturally reversible if the alien taxon is no longer present	Causes population decline in at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Causes reduction in individual performance (e.g., growth, reproduction, defence, immunocompetence), but no decline in local native population sizes	Negligible level of impact; no reduction in performance (e.g., growth, reproduction, defence, immunocompetence) of individuals of native taxa
Mechanisms					
(1) Competition	Competition resulting in replacement of one or several native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Competition resulting in local population extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Competition resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Competition affects performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	Negligible level of competition with native taxa; reduction of performance of native individuals is not detectable
(2) Predation	Predation results in local extinction of one or several native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Predation results in local population extinction of at least one native taxon; naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Predation results in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	The alien taxon preys on native taxa, without leading to a decline in their populations	Not applicable; predation on native taxa is classified at least as MN
(3) Hybridisation	Hybridisation between the alien taxon and native taxa leading to the loss of at least one pure native local population (genomic extinction); pure native taxa cannot be recovered even if the alien and hybrids are no longer present	Hybridisation between the alien taxon and native taxa leading to the loss of at least one pure native local population (genomic extinction); naturally reversible when the alien taxon and hybrids are no longer present	Hybridisation between the alien taxon and native taxa is regularly observed in the wild; local decline of populations of at least one pure native taxon, but pure native taxa persist	Hybridisation between the alien taxon and native taxa is observed in the wild, but rare; no decline of pure local native populations	No hybridisation between the alien taxon and native taxa observed in the wild (prezygotic barriers), hybridisation with a native taxon is possible in captivity

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(4) Transmission of disease to native species	Transmission of disease to native taxa resulting in local extinction of at least one native taxon; changes are naturally irreversible	Transmission of disease to native taxa resulting in local population extinction of at least one native taxon; naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Transmission of disease to native taxa resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction; disease is severely affecting native taxa, including mortality of individuals, and it has been found in native and alien co-occurring individuals (same time and space)	Transmission of disease to native taxa affects performance of native individuals without leading to a decline of their populations; alien taxon is a host of a disease which has also been detected in native taxa and affects the performance of native taxa	The alien taxon is a host or vector of a disease transmissible to native taxa but disease not detected in native taxa; reduction in performance of native individuals is not detectable
(5) Parasitism	Parasites or pathogens directly result in local extinction of one or several native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Parasites or pathogens directly result in local population extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Parasites or pathogens directly result in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Parasites or pathogens directly affect performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	Negligible level of parasitism or disease incidence (pathogens) on native taxa, reduction in performance of native individuals is not detectable
(6) Poisoning/toxicity	The alien taxon is toxic/allergenic by ingestion, inhalation, or contact to wildlife or allelopathic to plants, resulting in local extinction of at least one native taxon; changes are naturally irreversible	The alien taxon is toxic/allergenic by ingestion, inhalation, or contact to wildlife or allelopathic to plants, resulting in local population extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is removed	The alien taxon is toxic/allergenic by ingestion, inhalation, or contact to wildlife or allelopathic to plants, resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	The alien taxon is toxic/allergenic by ingestion, inhalation, or contact to wildlife or allelopathic to plants, affecting performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	The alien taxon is toxic/allergenic/allelopathic, but the level is very low, reduction of performance of native individuals is not detectable

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(7) Bio-fouling or other direct physical disturbance	Bio-fouling or other direct physical disturbance resulting in local extinction of one or several native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Bio-fouling or other direct physical disturbance resulting in local population extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Bio-fouling or other direct physical disturbance resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinctions	Bio-fouling or other direct physical disturbance affects performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	Negligible level of bio-fouling or direct physical disturbance on native taxa; reduction in performance of native individuals is not detectable
(8) Grazing/herbivory/browsing	Herbivory/grazing/browsing resulting in local extinction of one or several native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Herbivory/grazing/browsing resulting in local population extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Herbivory/grazing/browsing resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Herbivory/grazing/browsing affects performance of individuals of native taxa without decline of their populations	Negligible level of herbivory/grazing/browsing on native taxa, reduction in performance of native taxa is not detectable
(9) Chemical impact on ecosystems	Changes in chemical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in nutrient cycling, pH) resulting in local extinction of at least one native taxon; changes are naturally irreversible	Changes in chemical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in nutrient cycling, pH) resulting in local population extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Changes in chemical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in nutrient cycling, pH) resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Changes in chemical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in nutrient cycling, pH) affecting performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	Changes in chemical ecosystem characteristics detectable (e.g., changes in nutrient cycling, pH), but no reduction in performance of native individuals detectable

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(10) Physical impact on ecosystems	Changes in physical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in temperature, fire or light regime) resulting in local extinction of native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Changes in physical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in temperature, fire or light regime) resulting in local extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Changes in physical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in temperature, fire or light regime) resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Changes in physical ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in temperature, fire or light regime) affecting performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	Changes in physical ecosystem characteristics detectable (e.g., changes in temperature, fire or light regime), but no reduction in performance of native individuals detectable
(11) Structural impact on ecosystems	Changes in structural ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in architecture or complexity) resulting in local extinction of native taxa; changes are naturally irreversible	Changes in structural ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in architecture or complexity) resulting in local extinction of at least one native taxon, but changes are naturally reversible when the alien taxon is no longer present	Changes in structural ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in architecture or complexity) resulting in a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction	Changes in structural ecosystem characteristics (e.g., changes in architecture or complexity) affecting performance of native individuals without decline of their populations	Changes in structural ecosystem characteristics detectable (e.g., changes in architecture or complexity), but no reduction in performance of native individuals detectable
(12) Indirect impacts through interaction with other species	Interaction of an alien taxon with other taxa leading to indirect impacts (e.g., pollination, seed dispersal, apparent competition) causing local extinction of one or several native taxa, leading to naturally irreversible changes that would not have occurred in the absence of the alien taxon	Interaction of an alien taxon with other taxa leading to indirect impacts (e.g., pollination, seed dispersal, apparent competition) causing local extinction of at least one native taxon; changes are naturally reversible but would not have occurred in the absence of the alien taxon	Interaction of an alien taxon with other taxa leading to indirect impacts (e.g., pollination, seed dispersal, apparent competition) causing a decline of population size of at least one native taxon, but no local population extinction; impacts would not have occurred in the absence of the alien taxon	Interaction of an alien taxon with other taxa leading to indirect impacts (e.g., pollination, seed dispersal, apparent competition) affecting performance of native individuals without decline of their populations; impacts would not have occurred in the absence of the alien taxon	Interaction of an alien taxon with other taxa leading to indirect impacts (e.g., pollination, seed dispersal, apparent competition) but reduction in performance of native individuals is not detectable